

Participation

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight: 15%

Group project: Yes

Related Mentions

- Course Notes
- All course information is available through your Brightspace account. Brightspace is the primary channel of communication for this course so take note of announcements and other email messages you receive. Assignment and exam scores are posted there as well. You can also communicate directly with your Professor, your project team members, and other classmates from your section. Use this link to access Brightspace from your web browser and use your USC username and password to log in.
- Course Evaluation
- Participation 15%
- Active Class Participation
- Team Engagement
- Research Studies (2)
- Individual Assignments 30%
- Midterm Exam 15%
- Case Analysis Assignments 5%
- Final Reflection Paper 10%
- Team Project 30%
- Proposal & Team Contract 3%
- Paper 15%
- Presentation 10%
- Self & Peer Evaluation 2%
- Final Exam 25%
- Total 100%
- Final grades represent how you perform in the class relative to other students. Three items are considered

- when assigning final grades:
- 1. your weighted score as a percentage of the available points for all assignments (the points you receive
- divided by the number of points possible).
- 2. the overall average percentage score within the class.
- 3. your ranking among all students in the class.
- Participation
- Attendance Policy. Attendance is critical in this course. All missed classes will be noted. The policy on missed
- classes is to allow each student two (2) absences, no questions asked, no penalty. Missing three or more classes
- without a reasonable conversation with the professor will reduce your participation grade and final
- grade. Students with an excessive number of absences are at risk of failing the course. Only official
- university engagements, such as officially scheduled USC Marshall sponsored case competitions and sports
- events, will be accepted as exceptions to this policy. Job interviews are not excused so choose your absences
- carefully. Habitual lateness and leaving class early, for whatever reason, will be noted as evidence of low
- course commitment and penalized. Simply put, you cannot learn from our class discussions, and your
- classmates cannot learn from you, if you are not present.
- Participation. Your participation grade will be based on consistent and effective contributions to class
- discussions and participation in in-class assignments and activities. You are expected to attend every
- class
- session having read, thought about, and prepared any assigned material. You should also be
- prepared to share
- your ideas and to actively listen to and interpret the ideas presented by others. Effective engagement
- with your
- team is also an important component of your participation grade.
- 3
- Comments that are vague, repetitive, unrelated to the discussion, or disrespectful of others will be
- evaluated
- negatively. Quality comments possess one or more of the following attributes:
- • Offer a relevant concept or personal experience
- • Provide careful analysis by applying theory and concepts from readings and lectures
- • Move the discussion forward by building on previous contributions with new insights
- • Ask thoughtful and challenging questions.

- Our learning community operates in an environment of openness, respect, encouragement and engagement.
- Discussions will be richer if you share your unique perspective. There is rarely one right answer in organizational behavior! It may take courage or patience or imagination to engage with the course material,
- our classmates and our experiences. In our classroom, I aim to develop a psychologically safe space where
- we can all learn together and benefit from the diversity that leads to increased innovation, better problem
- solving and, in our case, what I hope will be new friends and a great semester!
- Research Studies Participation. Please refer to the Research Studies Participation document in Brightspace
- for more information on this component of your grade.
- Individual Assignments
- Midterm Exam. I will give an exam at the midpoint of the course to assess your understanding of material
- previously covered. The exam will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions.
- Please refer to the exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the topics covered, the format
- of the questions, and sample questions. Make-up exams are not permitted. I expect this exam to be
- administered in person.
- Case Analysis Assignments. To actively engage in case discussions, you will need to complete an analysis
- of the assigned case before attending class. Case preparation goes beyond simply reading the case. You
- are expected to use the USC-CT critical thinking framework to analyze the assigned case. You will identify
- critical problems and develop alternative solutions and an implementation plan. Be sure to watch the
- assigned USC-CT videos as noted in Week 1. Additional instructions will be posted to Brightspace.
- Final Reflection Paper. You will write a short personal reflection paper that describes how your team
- experience was influenced by different group properties and processes as well as reflect on your own
- behavior and learning. You will be assessed based on thoughtful, compelling and insightful writing and
- reflection, a strong connection between the experience and the learning or insights gained, and the use of
- specific detail and narrative accounts that convey an understanding of the experience supported by
- course
- material and personal assessment results. We strongly recommend that you maintain a learning journal or

- notes throughout the semester to aid in the writing at the end of the semester. Instructions and a grading
- rubric will be posted to Brightspace.
- Team Project
- You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The
- goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide
- you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze
- an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical
- interpersonal and teamwork skills.
- Your team will have a choice of conducting either:
- 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or
- other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that
- connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure
- and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make
- recommendations based on your study.
- 4
- 2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple
- organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or
- something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in
- detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best
- practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research).
- Your "deliverable" for this project has five components:
- 1. Project proposal with team contract
- 2. Detailed outline of paper
- 3. Project paper
- 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A
- 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class).
- Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch
- margins
- on all sides.
- Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team.

- As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective
- feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer
- evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace.
- The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the
- presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the
- analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of
- conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The
- detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper.
- Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace.
- Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on
- my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful
- consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.
- Final Exam
- The final exam will take place during the final examination period on the date and time assigned by the
- University. It will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions. Please refer to the
- exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the material covered. If you have another final
- exam scheduled on the same date and time as the final exam for this course, you must let me know about
- the conflict at least 2 weeks prior to the final exam. I expect this exam to be administered in person.
- Online Class Expectations - IF we move to an online format
- 1. Class attendance and participation are important to develop a coherent view of the materials covered in
- the course. Because BUAD 304 is highly interactive and experiential, attendance and active
- participation are required in the event of synchronous Zoom class sessions.
- a. First, please note that BUAD 304 in Fall 2026 is a residential class. All students are expected to be
- physically present in the classroom. In the event you cannot do so, you must contact the professor
- prior to classes beginning. This course is designed for in-person engagement, and OSAS
- Approved/Online only is not allowed at this time.
- 2. In the event we meet online for Zoom sessions, the following netiquette is expected, as if you were in

- a physical classroom.
- a. Please DO:
- i. Log into class early or promptly.
- ii. Arrange to attend class where there is a reliable internet connection and without distractions.
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- Participation
- Attendance Policy. Attendance is critical in this course. All missed classes will be noted. The policy on missed
- classes is to allow each student two (2) absences, no questions asked, no penalty. Missing three or more classes
- without a reasonable conversation with the professor will reduce your participation grade and final
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- grade. Students with an excessive number of absences are at risk of failing the course. Only official
- university engagements, such as officially scheduled USC Marshall sponsored case competitions and
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Full Syllabus Extract

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